

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣6

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥6

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥5

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ Q 10 8 5
♣ 10 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A J 7

♦ A K 6 2

♣ K Q J



♠ 9 7 4 2

♥ 10 4

♦ J 9

♣ A 9 7 6 3

♠ K 8 3

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ 7 4 3

♣ 8 5 2

With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution, NORTH opens 2NT.

SOUTH has just 3 points; he knows that NORTH cannot have more than 21 so the partnership total cannot be more than 24. So he just passes 2NT.

West

Pass

North

2NT

*East**South*

All Pass

2NT by North

Lead: ♣6

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ K 5 3
♦ K 5 3
♣ K 7 5 3

♠ J 9 8 7 6

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ 9 8

♣ 9 6



♠ A 4 2

♥ A 4 2

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ A 4 2

♠ Q 10

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q J 10 7

♣ Q J 10 8

This is an easy one to bid.

EAST has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

WEST has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks. Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣Q

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 4
♥ A 8 7 6
♦ 9 6 5 3
♣ 9 7

♠ K 7 2
♥ K J 5
♦ A 7 4 2
♣ Q J 8



♠ 10 9 8 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 10 8
♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ A J 5
♥ Q 10 9 3
♦ K Q J
♣ A K 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	6NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♥6			

Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then bid according to that answer.

Here NORTH has 14 points. So when SOUTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points NORTH knows the total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ K 7 4 3
♣ A 6 2

♠ 10 9 3

♥ J 10 6 5

♦ A 10

♣ K J 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 7 5

♥ Q 8 4

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

♠ J 8 4 2

♥ A 7 2

♦ J 9 8 5

♣ 9 4

EAST cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when WEST opens 1NT EAST knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so he passes again.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♥5